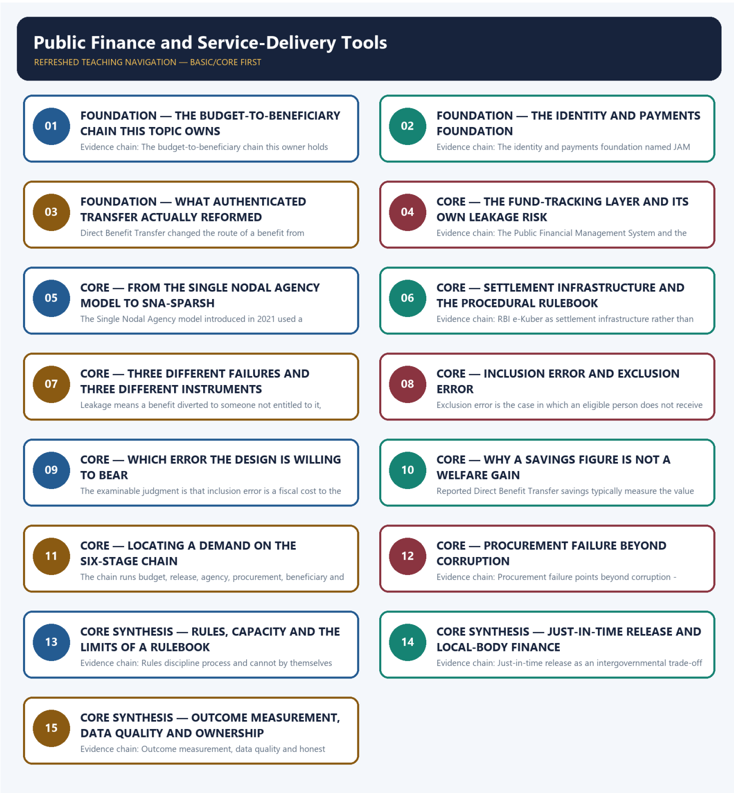
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Public Finance and Service-Delivery Tools - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Public Finance and Service-Delivery Tools - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The budget-to-beneficiary chain this owner holds?

A. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. B. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The budget-to-beneficiary chain this owner holds?

A. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. B. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The budget-to-beneficiary chain this owner holds?

A. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. B. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. C. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. D. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The budget-to-beneficiary chain this owner holds?

A. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. B. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. C. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. D. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The identity and payments foundation named JAM?

A. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. B. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level.

Answer: A. Explanation: The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The identity and payments foundation named JAM?

A. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. B. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. C. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. D. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Answer: B. Explanation: The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The identity and payments foundation named JAM?

A. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. B. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. C. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. D. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised.

Answer: C. Explanation: The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The identity and payments foundation named JAM?

A. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. B. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. C. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. D. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Direct Benefit Transfer is a payments reform broader than cash?

A. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. B. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. C. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. D. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded.

Answer: A. Explanation: Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Direct Benefit Transfer is a payments reform broader than cash?

A. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. B. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. C. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. D. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Answer: B. Explanation: Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Direct Benefit Transfer is a payments reform broader than cash?

A. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. B. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Answer: C. Explanation: Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Direct Benefit Transfer is a payments reform broader than cash?

A. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. B. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. C. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. D. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed.

Answer: D. Explanation: Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The Public Financial Management System and the agency layer?

A. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. B. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. C. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. D. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under The Public Financial Management System and the agency layer?

A. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. B. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. C. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. D. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Public Financial Management System and the agency layer?

A. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. B. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. C. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. D. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Public Financial Management System and the agency layer?

A. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. B. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. C. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. D. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through

release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The 2021 Single Nodal Agency model and its supersession?

A. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. B. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. C. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. D. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The 2021 Single Nodal Agency model and its supersession?

A. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. B. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. C. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. D. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The 2021 Single Nodal Agency model and its supersession?

A. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. B. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. C. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. D. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The 2021 Single Nodal Agency model and its supersession?

A. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. B. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. C. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. D. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies SNA-SPARSH, just-in-time release and its dated notification trail?

A. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. B. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. C. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. D. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised.

Answer: A. Explanation: SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under SNA-SPARSH, just-in-time release and its dated notification trail?

A. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. B. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. C. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. D. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix.

Answer: B. Explanation: SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of SNA-SPARSH, just-in-time release and its dated notification trail?

A. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. B. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. C. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. D. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.

Answer: C. Explanation: SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about SNA-SPARSH, just-in-time release and its dated notification trail?

A. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. B. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. C. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. D. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Answer: D. Explanation: SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies RBI e-Kuber as settlement infrastructure rather than policy?

A. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. B. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. C. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. D. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix.

Answer: A. Explanation: RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under RBI e-Kuber as settlement infrastructure rather than policy?

A. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. B. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. C. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. D. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove.

Answer: B. Explanation: RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of RBI e-Kuber as settlement infrastructure rather than policy?

A. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. B. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. C. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: C. Explanation: RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about RBI e-Kuber as settlement infrastructure rather than policy?

A. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. B. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. C. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. D. RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised.

Answer: D. Explanation: RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release

chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The General Financial Rules, 2017 as the procedural rulebook?

A. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. B. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. C. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. D. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.

Answer: A. Explanation: The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The General Financial Rules, 2017 as the procedural rulebook?

A. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. B. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. C. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. D. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove.

Answer: B. Explanation: The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The General Financial Rules, 2017 as the procedural rulebook?

A. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. B. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. C. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: C. Explanation: The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The General Financial Rules, 2017 as the procedural rulebook?

A. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. B. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named.

Answer: D. Explanation: The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three different failures?

A. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. B. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. C. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three different failures?

A. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. B. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. C. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. D. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number.

Answer: B. Explanation: Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three different failures?

A. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. B. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. C. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: C. Explanation: Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three different failures?

A. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. B. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. C. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. D. Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.

Answer: D. Explanation: Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Inclusion error and the instruments that reduce it?

A. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. B. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. C. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Inclusion error and the instruments that reduce it?

A. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. B. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number.

Answer: B. Explanation: Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Inclusion error and the instruments that reduce it?

A. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. B. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. C. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. D. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.

Answer: C. Explanation: Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Inclusion error and the instruments that reduce it?

A. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. B. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. C. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. D. Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix.

Answer: D. Explanation: Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Exclusion error and the correctives that reduce it?

A. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. B. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Exclusion error and the correctives that reduce it?

A. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. B. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.

Answer: B. Explanation: Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Exclusion error and the correctives that reduce it?

A. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. B. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. C. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. D. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.

Answer: C. Explanation: Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Exclusion error and the correctives that reduce it?

A. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. B. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. C. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. D. Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove.

Answer: D. Explanation: Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Which error the design is willing to bear?

A. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. B. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number.

Answer: A. Explanation: The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Which error the design is willing to bear?

A. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. B. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. C. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. D. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately.

Answer: B. Explanation: The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Which error the design is willing to bear?

A. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. B. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. C. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. D. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.

Answer: C. Explanation: The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Which error the design is willing to bear?

A. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. B. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. C. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. D. The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Answer: D. Explanation: The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Why a reported savings figure is not a net welfare gain?

A. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. B. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.

Answer: A. Explanation: Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Why a reported savings figure is not a net welfare gain?

A. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. B. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. C. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. D. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness.

Answer: B. Explanation: Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why a reported savings figure is not a net welfare gain?

A. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. B. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. C. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. D. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default.

Answer: C. Explanation: Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why a reported savings figure is not a net welfare gain?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. B. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. C. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. D. Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number.

Answer: D. Explanation: Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The six-stage budget-to-beneficiary chain as a routing device?

A. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. B. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. C. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. D. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness.

Answer: A. Explanation: The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The six-stage budget-to-beneficiary chain as a routing device?

A. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. B. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes;

leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. C. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. D. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness.

Answer: B. Explanation: The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The six-stage budget-to-beneficiary chain as a routing device?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. B. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. C. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. D. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness.

Answer: C. Explanation: The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The six-stage budget-to-beneficiary chain as a routing device?

A. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. B. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. C. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. D. The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately.

Answer: D. Explanation: The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Procurement failure points beyond corruption?

A. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. B. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. C. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. D. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied.

Answer: A. Explanation: Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Procurement failure points beyond corruption?

A. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. B. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. C. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. D. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Procurement failure points beyond corruption?

A. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. B. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. C. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. D. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Answer: C. Explanation: Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Procurement failure points beyond corruption?

A. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. B. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. C. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. D. Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.

Answer: D. Explanation: Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Procurement integrity instruments and the disclosure discipline?

A. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. B. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. C. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. D. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure.

Answer: A. Explanation: The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Procurement integrity instruments and the disclosure discipline?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. B. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. C. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. D. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied.

Answer: B. Explanation: The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Procurement integrity instruments and the disclosure discipline?

A. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. B. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. C. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. D. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure.

Answer: C. Explanation: The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Procurement integrity instruments and the disclosure discipline?

A. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. B. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. C. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. D. The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default.

Answer: D. Explanation: The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from

bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Rules discipline process and cannot by themselves produce value?

A. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. B. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. C. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. D. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied.

Answer: A. Explanation: The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Rules discipline process and cannot by themselves produce value?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. B. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. C. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct

Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. D. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Answer: B. Explanation: The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rules discipline process and cannot by themselves produce value?

A. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. B. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. C. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. D. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Answer: C. Explanation: The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with

responsiveness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rules discipline process and cannot by themselves produce value?

A. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. B. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. C. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. D. The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness.

Answer: D. Explanation: The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Just-in-time release as an intergovernmental trade-off with uneven incidence?

A. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. B. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. C. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the

Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. D. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Just-in-time release as an intergovernmental trade-off with uneven incidence?

A. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. B. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. C. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. D. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and

the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Just-in-time release as an intergovernmental trade-off with uneven incidence?

A. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. B. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. C. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. D. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Just-in-time release as an intergovernmental trade-off with uneven incidence?

A. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. B. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied.

Answer: D. Explanation: Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Local-body finance and the three-source test?

A. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. B. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. C. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. D. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(d) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and

the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Local-body finance and the three-source test?

A. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. B. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. C. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. D. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Local-body finance and the three-source test?

A. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. B. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. C. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. D. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Local-body finance and the three-source test?

A. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. B. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(c) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Article 280(3)(bb) directs the Union Finance Commission to recommend measures to augment a State's Consolidated Fund in order to supplement Panchayat resources and Article 280(3)(b) does the same for Municipalities, in each case on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations, and

the three-source test asks whether a local body has own revenue, State devolution through its Finance Commission and Union Finance Commission grants, because a body dependent on the third source alone has spending capacity without fiscal autonomy; tied grants protect national service priorities while untied resources preserve local choice, and transfer becomes accountable only with audited accounts, predictable release, a transparent formula and public disclosure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Outcome measurement, data quality and honest question ownership?

A. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. B. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. C. This topic owns the financial-flow chain that runs from budgetary appropriation to a delivered benefit, namely the Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile foundation, Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System, the Single Nodal Agency architecture and the General Financial Rules, 2017, together with procurement at the front end and outcome measurement at the back end of the same chain; the Aadhaar identity design itself is held by the digital public infrastructure owner and the constitutional status of the third tier by Polity, so this owner analyses how money moves and where delivery fails rather than restating identity architecture or constitutional provisions. D. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed.

Answer: A. Explanation: Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Outcome measurement, data quality and honest question ownership?

A. The JAM trinity is the combination of Jan Dhan universal bank-account access, Aadhaar unique identity and Mobile connectivity, and it is the technical precondition for targeted, verifiable benefit transfer at population scale because individual-level de-duplication needs a verifiable person, a usable account and a notification channel; the Department of Financial Services, whose official website was read on 2 September 2026, states that it is the nodal Department for the banking, financial services and insurance sector, that it administers various Acts relating to banking, insurance and pension, and that it executes reforms including the adoption of technology and cybersecurity measures to ensure ease, availability and security of financial services to citizens, and nothing beyond that statement of role is imported from it. B. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. C. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. D. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level.

Answer: B. Explanation: Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Outcome measurement, data quality and honest question ownership?

A. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. B. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. C. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. D. Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Outcome measurement, data quality and honest question ownership?

A. The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. B. The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. C. SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. D. Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Answer: D. Explanation: Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific

and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

One direct General Studies Paper-II Mains demand is routed to this topic across the audited ledgers, and its stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held OCR-searchable official question paper. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme and its limitations to the Advanced companion, and the Basic owner records expressly that core routing supersedes that older Advanced pointer and holds all marks-bearing content for the budget-to-beneficiary chain, so the demand is answered from the core file. No further Mains demand and no objective demand in the audited 2018-2023, 2024-2025 or 2026 ledgers is routed to this topic, so no additional demand card is manufactured and no question is invented from the locally held papers. No official answer key or marking scheme is held locally for the routed demand, so the model solution below is an authored answer route rather than an official key, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary count, scheme count, failure rate, coverage percentage, procurement threshold or portal statistic is recorded or inferred anywhere.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the governance concept and separate it from the nearest legal, institutional or measured category. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, delegated or executive authority and the competent level of government. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map state, market, civil-society, frontline and citizen stakeholders with power, duty and vulnerability. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace finance, information, implementation, monitoring, grievance, appeal and correction through the delivery chain. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, institution, scheme, audit, reform or local example with source, date and operative status. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test exclusion, digital divide, privacy, capture, capacity, indicator gaming, trade-off and residual-risk limits. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers names DBT/PFMS/SNA/GFR

directly, but this file's financial-flow framework is directly relevant background for any question on implementation efficiency, leakage reduction or service-delivery effectiveness (see `02`), and for GS-III-linked public-finance/subsidy-reform questions that intersect with GS-II governance-tool knowledge.

- ANALYSIS: Use the JAM-DBT-PFMS-SNA-GFR layered framework as the standard structuring device

whenever a question asks how India has improved financial-flow transparency or reduced welfare-scheme leakage.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Where a question links technology/digital tools to welfare-delivery efficiency

(echoing the 2025 e-governance user-centricity PYQ, see `05`), use the E1/E2 inclusion-exclusion framework from this file to give a balanced, not one-sided, efficiency assessment of DBT specifically.

- ANALYSIS: Where a question touches Centre-State fiscal relations (a recurring GS-II theme), cite

the SNA model's just-in-time release as a concrete, current illustration of the efficiency-versus-fiscal-flexibility tension between the Union and states.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	GS-II	8	Direct Benefit Transfer as reform and its limitations	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Direct Benefit Transfer as reform and its limitations

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment. Answer in 150 words for 10 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced companion and answered from the Basic owner under the recorded core routing that supersedes the older Advanced pointer, and confirmed word for word in the locally held OCR-searchable official 2022 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally, so the model solution is an authored answer route.

Model solution: Comment is an evaluative directive that requires a position with both sides shown, so the opening sentence must state precisely what was reformed rather than praising digitisation in general. Say that the scheme changed the route of a benefit, moving it from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and that this attacked identity-based leakage specifically. Give the mechanism in one line: population-scale identity together with universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale that manual verification never allowed, which is why fake, duplicate and ineligible entries in ration-card, job-card and subsidy registries could be removed. Add the scope precision most answers miss, namely that the instrument is not only cash, because it also covers in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so equating it with cash transfer is a scope error. Concede the genuine gains before criticising, or the comment is one-sided: intermediation fell, timeliness improved for most recipients and an auditable payment trail now exists. Then take the limitations in the correct analytical order. First, the instrument addresses leakage and not targeting, so a wrong or outdated beneficiary list transfers money accurately to the wrong people. Second, exclusion error is created by the same verification mechanism, because authentication failure, seeding and name mismatch, missing documents, dormant or frozen accounts and distance deny genuine beneficiaries, and that failure falls hardest on manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. Third, last-mile access matters, because a credited account is not money in hand where the banking correspondent, connectivity or distance intervenes. Fourth, cash is not a substitute for provision, so where a market does not exist or prices are volatile the transfer shifts price risk to the poorest. Fifth, payment-failure grievance is weak and often has no named addressee. Sixth, the savings claim measures the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, because it does not net out exclusion cost. Map correctives to those limitations rather than listing them loosely: assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision as a targeting fix rather than a payments fix, a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline, and the reporting of exclusion as a monitored metric alongside savings. Conclude with the verdict that this is a successful payments reform being asked to carry the weight of a targeting and provision reform it was never designed to deliver. Assert no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary count, scheme count or authentication-failure rate.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Comment is an evaluative directive that requires a position with both sides shown, so the opening sentence must state precisely what was reformed rather than praising digitisation in general. Say that the scheme changed the route of a benefit, moving it from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and that this attacked identity-based leakage specifically. Give the mechanism in one line: population-scale identity together with universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale that manual verification never allowed, which is why fake, duplicate and ineligible entries in ration-card, job-card and subsidy registries could be removed. Add the scope precision most answers miss, namely that the instrument is not only cash, because it also covers in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so equating it with cash transfer is a scope error. Concede the genuine gains before criticising, or the comment is one-sided: intermediation fell, timeliness improved for most recipients and an auditable payment trail now exists. Then take the limitations in the correct analytical order. First, the instrument addresses leakage and not targeting, so a wrong or outdated beneficiary list transfers money accurately to the wrong people. Second, exclusion error is created by the same verification mechanism, because authentication failure, seeding and name mismatch, missing documents, dormant or frozen accounts and distance deny genuine beneficiaries, and that failure falls hardest on manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. Third, last-mile access matters, because a credited account is not money in hand where the banking correspondent, connectivity or distance intervenes. Fourth, cash is not a substitute for provision, so where a market does not exist or prices are volatile the transfer shifts price risk to the poorest. Fifth, payment-failure grievance is weak and often has no named addressee. Sixth, the savings claim measures the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, because it does not net out exclusion cost. Map correctives to those limitations rather than listing them loosely: assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision as a targeting fix rather than a payments fix, a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline, and the reporting of exclusion as a monitored metric alongside savings. Conclude with the verdict that this is a successful payments reform being asked to carry the weight of a targeting and provision reform it was never designed to deliver. Assert no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary count, scheme count or authentication-failure rate.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Reforming the government delivery system through the Direct Benefit Transfer Scheme is a progressive step, but it has its limitations too. Comment. Answer in 150 words for 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Comment is an evaluative directive that requires a position with both sides shown, so the opening sentence must state precisely what was reformed rather than praising digitisation in general. Say that the scheme changed the route of a benefit, moving it from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and that this attacked identity-based leakage specifically. Give the mechanism in one line: population-scale identity together with universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale that manual verification never allowed, which is why fake, duplicate and ineligible entries in ration-card, job-card and subsidy registries could be removed. Add the scope precision most answers miss, namely that the instrument is not only cash, because it also covers in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so equating it with cash transfer is a scope error. Concede the genuine gains before criticising, or the comment is one-sided: intermediation fell, timeliness improved for most recipients and an auditable payment trail now exists. Then take the limitations in the correct analytical order. First, the instrument addresses leakage and not targeting, so a wrong or outdated beneficiary list transfers money accurately to the wrong people. Second, exclusion error is created by the same verification mechanism, because authentication failure, seeding and name mismatch, missing documents, dormant or frozen accounts and distance deny genuine beneficiaries, and that failure falls hardest on manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. Third, last-mile access matters, because a credited account is not money in hand where the banking correspondent, connectivity or distance intervenes. Fourth, cash is not a substitute for provision, so where a market does not exist or prices are volatile the transfer shifts price risk to the poorest. Fifth, payment-failure grievance is weak and often has no named addressee. Sixth, the savings claim measures the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, because it does not net out exclusion cost. Map correctives to those limitations rather than listing them loosely: assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision as a targeting fix rather than a payments fix, a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline, and the reporting of exclusion as a monitored metric alongside savings. Conclude with the verdict that this is a successful payments reform being asked to carry the weight of a targeting and provision reform it was never designed to deliver. Assert no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary count, scheme count or authentication-failure rate.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the roles of Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture within India's public financial management. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The three tools are not synonyms but three layers answering three different failures, namely beneficiary-level identity leakage, agency-level diversion and idle balance, and Union-to-State release float, so the answer must assign each tool its own problem, mechanism and limitation rather than describing one digital system.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed.
- The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level.
- The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded.
- SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being

parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.

Qualified conclusion: The three tools are not synonyms but three layers answering three different failures, namely beneficiary-level identity leakage, agency-level diversion and idle balance, and Union-to-State release float, so the answer must assign each tool its own problem, mechanism and limitation rather than describing one digital system.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish the roles of Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The three tools are not synonyms but three layers answering three different failures, namely beneficiary-level identity leakage, agency-level diversion and idle balance, and Union-to-State release float, so the answer must assign each tool its own problem, mechanism and limitation rather than describing one digital system.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Direct Benefit Transfer changed the route of a benefit from intermediated, physically distributed or price-subsidised delivery to authenticated transfer to a verified beneficiary, and it covers cash transfers to individuals, in-kind benefits delivered through authenticated systems and certain transfers to service enablers, so treating it as a synonym for cash transfer is a scope error; its distinctive achievement is that population-scale identity plus universal bank access makes individual-level de-duplication possible at a scale manual verification never allowed. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Single Nodal Agency model introduced in 2021 used a designated agency and account structure for each centrally sponsored scheme so that scheme balances held in State accounts became visible, and it applies specifically to the State-level fund flow of centrally sponsored schemes rather than to central-sector schemes, to Finance Commission grants or to government expenditure generally; describing that bank-account model as the whole of the present architecture is the standard error, because the release design has since been superseded. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026;

applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The three tools are not synonyms but three layers answering three different failures, namely beneficiary-level identity leakage, agency-level diversion and idle balance, and Union-to-State release float, so the answer must assign each tool its own problem, mechanism and limitation rather than describing one digital system.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish the roles of Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how just-in-time release in the current centrally sponsored scheme architecture alters Centre-State fiscal relations. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Just-in-time release converts a fiscal-efficiency gain at the Union level into a cash-planning constraint at the State level, so the answer must name the integration that makes it possible, the float it removes and the reconciliation load it creates, and must end with a negotiated balance rather than a one-sided efficiency mandate.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all.
- RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised.
- Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied.
- The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the

counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately.

Qualified conclusion: Just-in-time release converts a fiscal-efficiency gain at the Union level into a cash-planning constraint at the State level, so the answer must name the integration that makes it possible, the float it removes and the reconciliation load it creates, and must end with a negotiated balance rather than a one-sided efficiency mandate.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain how just-in-time release in the current centrally sponsored scheme architecture...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Just-in-time release converts a fiscal-efficiency gain at the Union level into a cash-planning constraint at the State level, so the answer must name the integration that makes it possible, the float it removes and the reconciliation load it creates, and must end with a negotiated balance rather than a one-sided efficiency mandate.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** SNA-SPARSH is the current official just-in-time architecture for centrally sponsored schemes and integrates the Public Financial Management System, the State Integrated Financial Management Information System and RBI e-Kuber so that Union and State shares are released together against actual expenditure claims instead of being parked in advance; it was introduced by Department of Expenditure Office Memorandum No. 1(27)/PFMS/2020 dated 13 July 2023, an Office Memorandum of 10 June 2025 extended it to thirty-seven further schemes from 1 July 2025, and from 1 November 2025 it applies to all centrally sponsored schemes in States and Union Territories with legislatures, as re-verified by the owners on 13 August 2026; applicability by notification is not verified operational onboarding, so the defensible formulation is applicable from rather than operational in all. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** RBI e-Kuber settles transfers between the Union's account and the State's account at the Reserve Bank of India without commercial-bank float, and it is an infrastructure component of the release chain rather than a policy instrument in its own right, so an answer that presents it as a reform misplaces it; its function is to make just-in-time release technically possible once the scheme share and the expenditure claim have been authorised. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Just-in-time release genuinely removes idle float and genuinely constrains State cash planning, so efficiency at the Union level is purchased with State fiscal flexibility and with a heavy reconciliation load on implementing agencies, and the incidence is uneven because the beneficiary bears authentication, travel and account-access cost, the banking correspondent is the actual last mile with commission incentives, the State finance department loses a cash buffer and gains reporting obligations, and the Union ministry gains visibility and real-time control; the reform is defensible only where that cost is acknowledged rather than denied. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. **Analysis:**

Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Just-in-time release converts a fiscal-efficiency gain at the Union level into a cash-planning constraint at the State level, so the answer must name the integration that makes it possible, the float it removes and the reconciliation load it creates, and must end with a negotiated balance rather than a one-sided efficiency mandate.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain how just-in-time release in the current centrally sponsored scheme architecture...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Critically examine the proposition that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses leakage rather than targeting accuracy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The proposition is correct but incomplete, because leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three distinct failures and the same verification mechanism that reduces inclusion error raises exclusion error, so a critical examination must concede the genuine payments gain, separate the three failures and state which error the design is willing to bear.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.
- Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix.
- Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove.
- The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition is correct but incomplete, because leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three distinct failures and the same verification mechanism that reduces inclusion error raises exclusion error, so a critical examination must concede the genuine payments gain, separate the three failures and state which error the design is willing to bear.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Critically examine the proposition that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses leakage rather than...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The proposition is correct but incomplete, because leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three distinct failures and the same verification mechanism that reduces inclusion error raises exclusion error, so a critical examination must concede the genuine payments gain, separate the three failures and state which error the design is willing to bear.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusion error is the case in which an ineligible person receives the benefit, and it arises from fake or duplicate entries, from outdated lists and from false declaration, so the instruments that reduce it are authentication, de-duplication and verification; every tightening of those instruments raises exclusion error, which is why inclusion error cannot be minimised in isolation and why de-duplication is a payments fix rather than a list fix. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The examinable judgment is that inclusion error is a fiscal cost to the state while exclusion error is a subsistence cost to a person, so for food, pension and wage entitlements the asymmetry justifies tolerating some inclusion error in order to protect against exclusion, and the marks are earned by stating which error the design is optimising against and why, rather than by claiming that total targeting error can be minimised; the failure of authentication falls hardest on the least-equipped, including manual labourers with worn fingerprints, elderly users and residents of low-connectivity areas. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative

status.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition is correct but incomplete, because leakage, exclusion and inefficiency are three distinct failures and the same verification mechanism that reduces inclusion error raises exclusion error, so a critical examination must concede the genuine payments gain, separate the three failures and state which error the design is willing to bear.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Critically examine the proposition that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses leakage rather than...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why reported savings from authenticated benefit transfer cannot by themselves establish that welfare delivery has improved. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: A savings figure measures removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, is bound to its reporting date and omits the exclusion cost, so the honest evaluation reports exclusion as a metric alongside savings and reasons from the mechanism instead of from a dashboard total.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number.
- Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove.
- Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires.
- Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Qualified conclusion: A savings figure measures removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, is bound to its reporting date and omits the exclusion cost, so the honest evaluation reports exclusion as a metric alongside savings and reasons from the mechanism instead of from a dashboard total.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why reported savings from authenticated benefit transfer cannot by themselves...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A savings figure measures removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, is bound to its reporting date and omits the exclusion cost, so the honest evaluation reports exclusion as a metric alongside savings and reasons from the mechanism instead of from a dashboard total.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Reported Direct Benefit Transfer savings typically measure the value of removed ineligible and duplicate entries, which is a different and generally larger number than a net welfare gain because it does not net out the exclusion cost borne by genuine beneficiaries, and dashboard totals are reporting-date-bound and rise continuously as more schemes and years are covered; the durable, exam-safe proposition is therefore the mechanism, namely that savings arise from removing fake, duplicate and ineligible entries, and no cumulative rupee total may be asserted as a permanently citable number. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Exclusion error is the case in which an eligible person does not receive the benefit, and it arises from authentication failure, from seeding and name mismatch, from missing documents, from distance, from dormant or frozen accounts and from lists that are never revised, so the correctives are assisted and offline authentication fallback, exception handling with a named officer, periodic beneficiary-list revision and a payment-grievance route with a stated timeline; each corrective raises inclusion error and administrative cost, and manual override reintroduces part of the discretion that authenticated transfer was designed to remove. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Leakage means a benefit diverted to someone not entitled to it, exclusion means a benefit never reaching an eligible person, and inefficiency means a benefit delivered at excessive cost, and these are three separate failures needing three different instruments that are routinely merged into the single phrase about plugging the leakages, which is why such recommendations rarely change outcomes; naming which of the three a stem is actually about is the first analytical move this topic requires. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative

status.

Qualified conclusion: A savings figure measures removed ineligible and duplicate entries rather than a net welfare gain, is bound to its reporting date and omits the exclusion cost, so the honest evaluation reports exclusion as a metric alongside savings and reasons from the mechanism instead of from a dashboard total.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine why reported savings from authenticated benefit transfer cannot by themselves...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess India's budget-to-beneficiary chain by locating the distinct failure at each stage and the instrument that addresses it. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The chain is a diagnostic device rather than a description, because each of its six stages fails in its own way and each failure has its own instrument, so a full assessment traces the money from appropriation to outcome, separates leakage, exclusion, inefficiency and federal capacity as distinct evaluative axes and closes with a reversal condition.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately.
- The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level.
- Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.
- Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package.

Qualified conclusion: The chain is a diagnostic device rather than a description, because each of its six stages fails in its own way and each failure has its own instrument, so a full assessment traces the money from appropriation to outcome, separates leakage, exclusion, inefficiency and federal capacity as distinct evaluative axes and closes with a reversal condition.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess India's budget-to-beneficiary chain by locating the distinct failure at each stage and...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The chain is a diagnostic device rather than a description, because each of its six stages fails in its own way and each failure has its own instrument, so a full assessment traces the money from appropriation to outcome, separates leakage, exclusion, inefficiency and federal capacity as distinct evaluative axes and closes with a reversal condition.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The chain runs budget, release, agency, procurement, beneficiary and outcome, and each stage carries its own characteristic failure, namely an unrealistic outlay, delay and float and parking, diversion and idle balance, specification and competition and contract-management failure, exclusion and last-mile cash access, and the counting of outputs in place of outcomes; leakage stems sit at stages three to five, delay stems at stage two, value-for-money stems at stage four and did-it-work stems at stage six, so answering a procurement demand with benefit-transfer material is a routing error the examiner will see immediately. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Public Financial Management System, administered by the Department of Expenditure in the Ministry of Finance, tracks government funds end to end from budgetary sanction through release to implementing agencies down to actual utilisation, and it supplies sanction, payment and authorised management reporting including the Know Your Payment facility, so it addresses diversion and idle balances at the agency and intermediary level, which is a different leakage risk from the beneficiary-level risk that Direct Benefit Transfer addresses; not every internal utilisation trail is public at beneficiary level. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Outcome budgeting and the output-outcome monitoring framework attach outcome indicators to financial allocation and form the back end of the chain, although coverage is scheme-specific and output reporting still dominates, while the reliability of the tracking layer depends on accurate and timely data entry at the implementing-agency level, which is a persistent and under-examined constraint. On ownership, the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes one General Studies Paper-II demand on Direct Benefit Transfer as a reform and its limitations to this topic, the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older pointer to the Advanced companion, and no cumulative savings figure, beneficiary or scheme count, authentication or payment-failure rate, tracking-coverage percentage, procurement threshold, portal statistic or State fund-utilisation figure is asserted anywhere in this package. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the

jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The chain is a diagnostic device rather than a description, because each of its six stages fails in its own way and each failure has its own instrument, so a full assessment traces the money from appropriation to outcome, separates leakage, exclusion, inefficiency and federal capacity as distinct evaluative axes and closes with a reversal condition.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess India's budget-to-beneficiary chain by locating the distinct failure at each stage and...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess whether procedural rules can deliver value for money in public procurement, and state what else is required. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Rules discipline process and cannot produce value, because specification quality, market competition and contract management determine outcomes and no rulebook supplies them, so the defensible position is that integrity instruments are necessary, insufficient and themselves costly in time and in supplier participation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids.
- The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default.
- The General Financial Rules and the procurement rules supply ex-ante procedural discipline while the Public Financial Management System supplies real-time and ex-post tracking visibility, so the two are complementary and neither substitutes for the other, and the binding constraints on procurement outcomes are specification quality, market competition and contract management, none of which a rulebook can supply; the rules-against-capacity answer therefore concedes that predictability is bought with responsiveness.
- The General Financial Rules were comprehensively revised in 2017 and remain the Union government's consolidated rulebook on financial management, budgeting, sanctioning, procurement and expenditure control, and Direct Benefit Transfer, the Public Financial Management System and the Single Nodal Agency architecture all operate within them rather than replacing them; periodic amendments have followed without a fresh comprehensive revision superseding the 2017 edition, so the year must be cited whenever the rulebook is named.

Qualified conclusion: Rules discipline process and cannot produce value, because specification quality, market competition and contract management determine outcomes and no rulebook supplies them, so the defensible position is that integrity instruments are necessary, insufficient and themselves costly in time and in supplier participation.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess whether procedural rules can deliver value for money in public procurement, and state...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Rules discipline process and cannot produce value, because specification quality, market competition and contract management determine outcomes and no rulebook supplies them, so the defensible position is that integrity instruments are necessary, insufficient and themselves costly in time and in supplier participation.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Union procurement operates within the General Financial Rules, 2017 and the applicable procurement rules and manuals with the stated objective of value for money together with transparency, competition, fairness and non-discrimination, and its failures extend well beyond corruption to over-specified or vendor-tailored specifications, to single-bid and limited-competition outcomes, to lowest-cost selection for quality-dependent services, to weak contract management after award and to inadequate capacity to evaluate technically complex bids. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The integrity instruments a governance answer should name are conflict-of-interest disclosure, debarment of defaulting suppliers, independent complaint handling before award and audit of the award decision, together with the discipline that confidentiality of adverse information does not extinguish the duty to disclose the risk to the competent authority; the accompanying trade-off is that tighter procurement rules raise process integrity while lengthening timelines and deterring capable suppliers from bidding, and an honest answer names both sides instead of recommending more rules by default. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
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Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative

status.

Qualified conclusion: Rules discipline process and cannot produce value, because specification quality, market competition and contract management determine outcomes and no rulebook supplies them, so the defensible position is that integrity instruments are necessary, insufficient and themselves costly in time and in supplier participation.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess whether procedural rules can deliver value for money in public procurement, and state...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.